Configuring Rails for Front-End Development

All the tools for Hotwire and our bundle are available as part of the options for a standard `rails new` command. I'll talk about installing TypeScript in *Adding TypeScript* and React in Chapter 4, *React*. We are not using not the default options for Rails, which I'll talk about in Chapter 7, *Bundling*.

For the project in this book, I started a new Rails project with this command (it's a single line when you use it, but split here to fit on the page):

```
bundle exec rails new . -a propshaft -j esbuild
  --database postgresql --skip-test --css tailwind
```

This gives us a standard Rails application with the following overrides:

- We are using PostgreSQL as the database instead of the default SQLite.
- We are skipping the installation of the default test library because we're going to add in RSpec later.
- We are using Propshaft as the asset handler rather than the default Sprockets, which we'll look at in *Propshaft*.
- We are using jsbundling-rails with esbuild for JavaScript building rather than the default, which is importmap-rails.
- We are using the Tailwind[26] CLI for CSS packaging, rather than the default, which is nothing.

With these options, you get a few gems installed, and then some manifest and configuration files, and a startup script to load everything.

As we write front-end code, our developer setup will respond and send new data to the browser. The work flow is as follows:

- We will write code, which might be JavaScript, TypeScript, JSX, TSX, or